

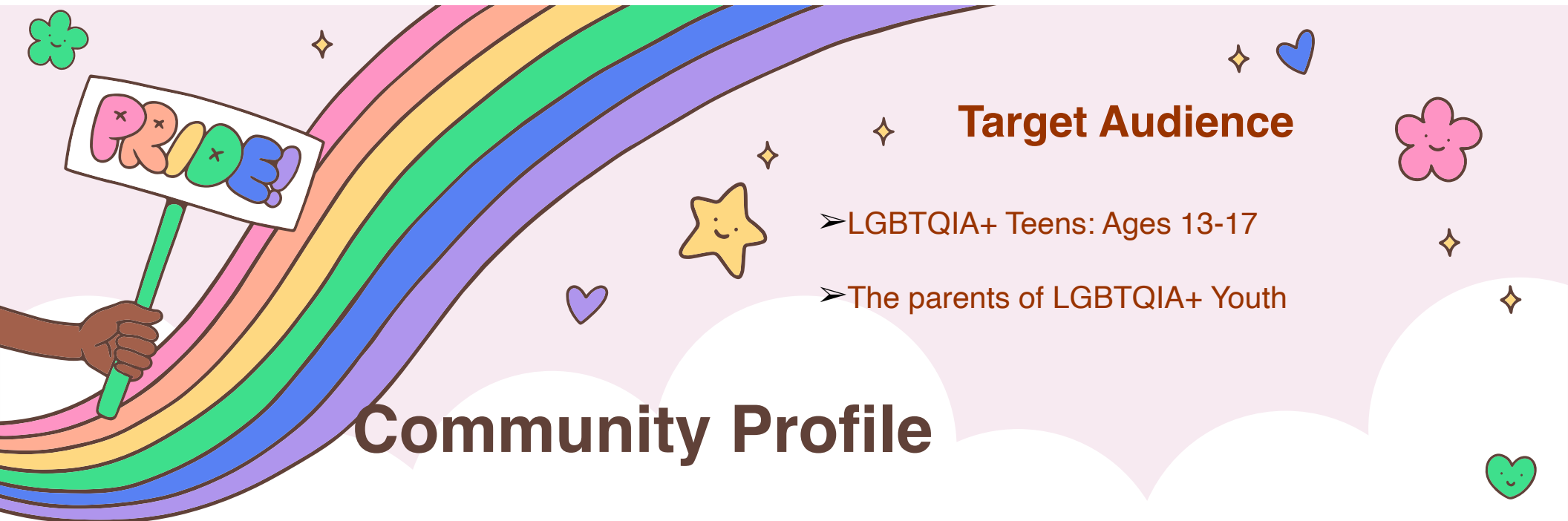


Rainbow Reading Club

A Book club for LGBTQIA+ youth, Ages
13-17



chandlerpublic
LIBRARY



Target Audience

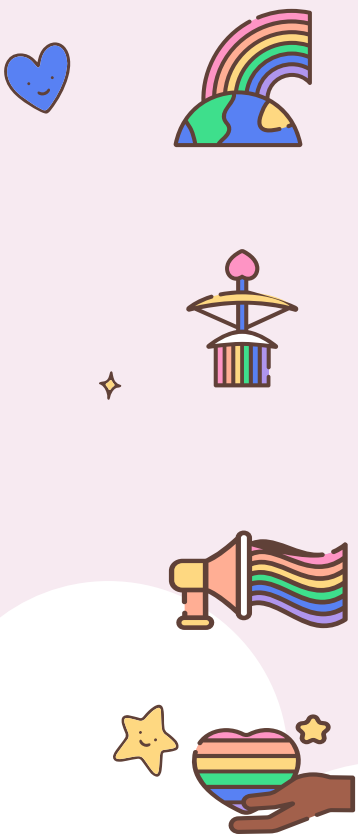
- LGBTQIA+ Teens: Ages 13-17
- The parents of LGBTQIA+ Youth

Community Profile

- 9.5% of the American population ages 13 - 17 identify as LGBTQ+ (Conron, 2020)
- Only 26.4% of youth aged 13 - 17 are out to all of their immediate family (The Trevor Project, 2024)
- 18% of the queer population ages 13 - 17 attempted suicide in 2023 (The Trevor Project, 2024)

Community Profile Cont'd

- Queer teens find online communities to get acceptance and assistance (Robinson & Schmitz 2021)
- Familial disapproval leads some queer youth to homelessness (Mitsdarffer et al., 2023)
- Queer youth are often feel isolated due to lack of familial and social acceptance, leading to mental health issues, homelessness, and substance abuse (Cunningham et al., 2014)



Community Needs and Strengths

Needs

- Social and emotional support
- Safe spaces
- Affirmation and guidance during gender transition (Sava et al., 2021)

Strengths

- Open-minded and accepting
- Adaptable and versatile
- Tech Savvy (Robinson & Schmitz 2021)

Program Overview and Goals

The goal of the Rainbow Reading Club program is to provide a safe and supportive space for teens who identify as part of the LGBTQ+ community and provide them with a positive, supportive community of their peers. Our club seeks to combat this isolation by providing :

- A sense of community through reading and online forums.
- Meeting virtually and messaging in monitored, safe environment
- Creating lifelong readers
- Engaging LGBTQ+ teens with the queer literature in our collection
- Getting parents to engage positively with their children's identity



Program Components



01

Assigned Books

02



Monthly Online discussion



03

Online community Chats



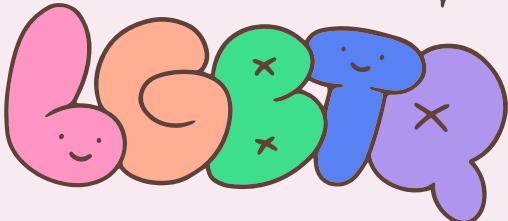
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Reading Group Website



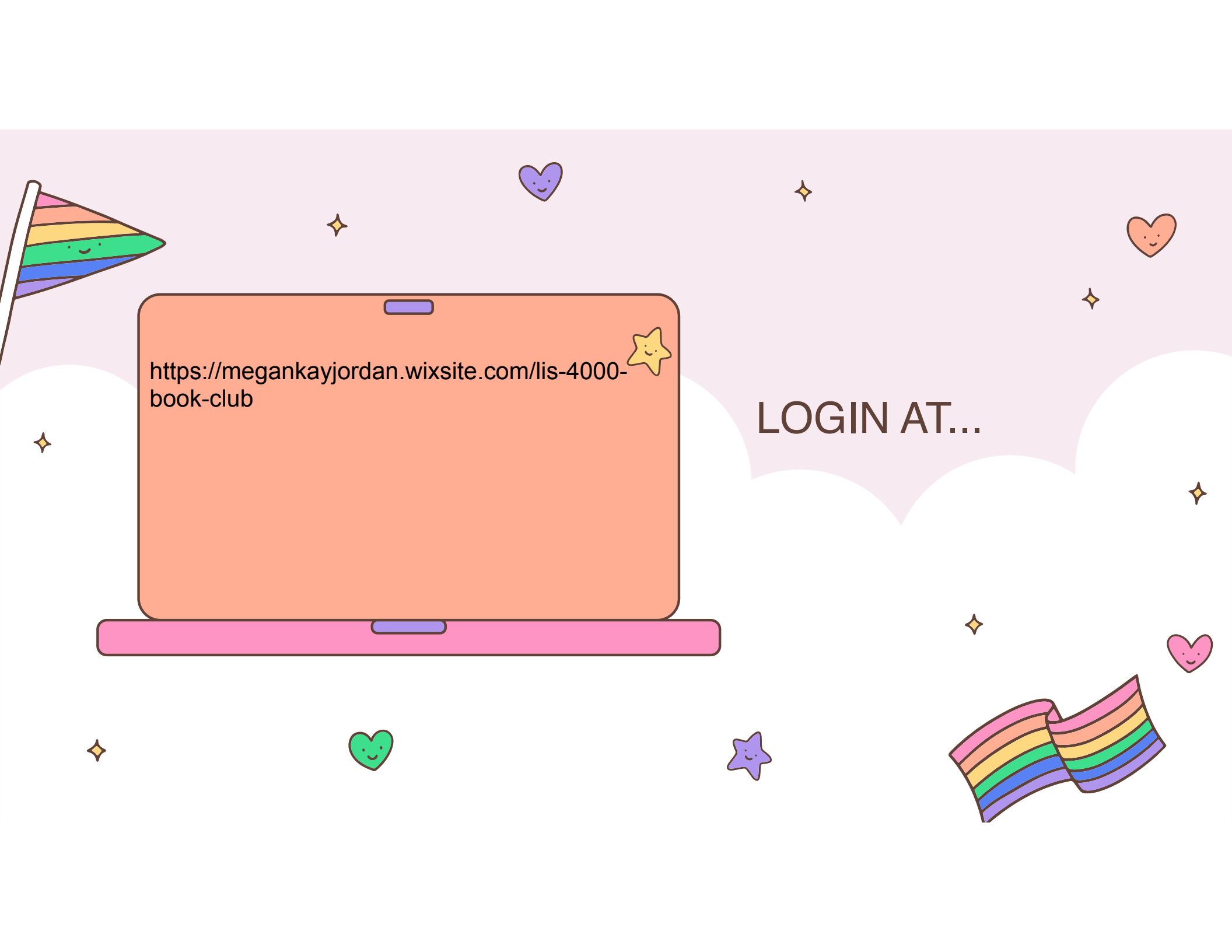


Ex. READING AND DISCUSSION
Components



1st of the month	Assign LGBTQ+ young adult novel or non-fiction work
Third Saturday of the month	Participants meet in the online book chat hosted by the librarian for one hour of discussion
Any time	Online chat room is always available so that community members can connect and discuss their identities in a safe place to find friendships and community.
Reading Guides	The librarian will post study questions with each reading online to stimulate substantive thought on LGBTQ+ issues and critical reading.
Resources	Links and contact information for LGBTQ+ resources applicable to their age group
Lib Guide	They will have access to a guide to LGBTQ+ literature to stimulate further engagement with the collection



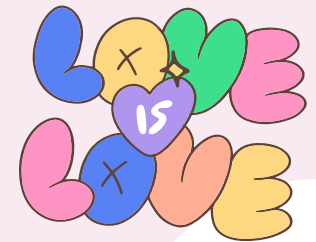


<https://megankayjordan.wixsite.com/lis-4000-book-club>

LOGIN AT...



Our Community Partners



Groups

One-N-Ten : <https://oneten.org/>

The Trevor Project: <https://www.thetrevorproject.org/>

Therapists

The Alphabet Mafia

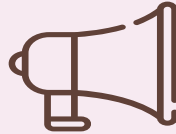
Clinics

Here4U



Program Promotion[✦]

- Social media: Library Facebook Page, TikTok Ad, etc.



- Library: library website ,pamphlets, and signs
- Schools: Advertise with fliers for the program through the school administrators



Funding

- Library programming funds
- sponsorship from 1N10, Here 4U, The Alphabet Mafia



References

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The Trevor Project. (2022, December 15) 2022 national survey on LGBTQ Youth Mental Health. <https://www.thetrevorproject.org/survey-2022/>

Mitsdarffer, M. L., McColl, R., Nescott, E., Bianchetta, J., Layland, E. K., & Tóth, T. (2023). LGBTQ+ Youth Homelessness in Delaware: Building a Case for Targeted Surveillance and Assessment of LGBTQ+ Youth Needs and Experiences. *Delaware Journal of Public Health*, 9(2), 80–86. <https://doi.org/10.32481/djph.2023.06.014>

Robinson, B.A., Schmitz, R.M. (2021) Beyond resilience: Resistance in the lives of LGBTQ youth. *Sociology Compass*. <https://doi.org/10.1111/soc4.12947>

